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February 9, 1973
SUPERSEDING
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March 23, 1966

FEDERAL SPECIFICATION

BAG, PAPER, SHOPPING

This specification was approved by the Commissioner, Federal Supply Service, General Services Administration for the use of all Federal agencies.

1. SCOPE AND CLASSIFICATION

1.1 Scope. This specification covers the requirements for shopping bags of standard sizes and weights of paper stock that are in general demand. The minimum basis weights and strengths of paper are also established.

1.2 Classification.

1.2.1 Types. Shopping bags covered by this specification shall be of the following types, as specified (see 6.1):

Type I - Bags, satchel-bottom.
Type II - Bags, self-opening.

1.2.2 Sizes. The size (capacity) of the bags shall conform to table I, as specified (3.3 and 6.2).

2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

2.1 The following documents, of the issues in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal, form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein.

Federal Specifications:

UU-P-268 - Paper, Kraft, Untreated, Wrapping.
PPP-B-636 - Box, Shipping, Fiberboard.

Federal Standard:

Fed. Std. No. 123 - Marking for Domestic Shipment (Civil Agencies).

(Activities outside the Federal Government may obtain copies of Federal Specifications, Standards, and Handbooks as outlined under General Information in the Index of Federal Specifications and Standards and at the prices indicated in the Index. The Index, which includes cumulative monthly supplements as issued, is for sale on a subscription basis by the Superintendent of Documents, U. S. Government Printing Office, Washington, DC 20402.

(Single copies of this specification and other Federal Specifications required by activities outside the Federal Government for bidding purposes are available without charge from Business Service Centers at the General Services Administration Regional Offices in Boston, New York, Washington, DC Atlanta, Chicago, Kansas City, MO, Fort Worth, Denver, San Francisco, Los Angeles, and Seattle, WA.

(Federal Government activities may obtain copies of Federal Specifications, Standards, and Handbooks and the Index of Federal Specifications and Standards from established distribution points in their agencies.)

Military Specification:

MIL-A-140 - Adhesive, Water-Resistant, Waterproof Barrier Material.

Military Standards:

MIL-STD-105 - Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes.
MIL-STD-129 - Marking for Shipment and Storage.

(Copies of Military Specifications and Standards required by contractors in connection with specific procurement functions should be obtained from the procuring agency or as directed by the contracting officer.

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2.2 Other publications. The following documents form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein. Unless a specific issue is identified, the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal shall apply.

National Motor Freight Traffic Association, Incorporated, Agent.

National Motor Freight Classification.

(Application for copies should be addressed to the American Trucking Associations, Inc., Tariff Order Section, 1616 P Street, NW, Washington, DC 20036.)

Uniform Classification Committee, Agent:

Uniform Freight Classification.

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Uniform Classification Committee, Room 1106, 222 South Riverside Plaza, Chicago, IL 60606.)

Technical Association of the Pulp and Paper Industry (TAPPI) Publications:

T401 - Fiber Analysis of Paper and Paperboard.
T402 - Conditioning Paper and Paperboard for Testing.
T403 - Bursting Strength of Paper.
T408 - Rosin in Paper and Paperboard.
T410 - Weight Per Unit Area (Basis Weight or Substance) of Paper and Paperboard.
T414 - Internal Tearing Resistance of Paper.

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Technical Association of the Pulp and Paper Industry, One Dunwoody Park, Atlanta, GA 30341.)

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 Material. The paper used in the fabrication of the shopping bags, shall consist of 100 percent unbleached sulphate (kraft) fiber and shall conform to the applicable requirements in table II for basis weight, tearing resistance and bursting strength. The paper shall be rosin sized.

3.1.1 Type I. The basis weight of paper for type I bags, shall be 60 pounds (24 x 36 - 500).

3.1.2 Type II. The basis weight of paper for type II bags, shall be 65 pounds (24 x 36 - 500).

3.1.3 Bags of other weights of paper. When this specification is cited in procurements of shopping bags with weights of paper other than those specified in table II, the paper shall have a bursting strength in points equal to 70 percent of the basis weight; and a minimum average tearing resistance, machine direction, in grams, equal to 185 percent of the basis weight.

3.2 Construction. Shopping bags shall be so constructed that all seams shall adhere securely throughout their area. All seams shall be not less than 1/2 inch wide throughout their length when separated manually and examined. At least 75 percent of the seam area shall show evidence of fiber pick.

3.2.1 Handles. Handles shall be made of twisted kraft paper cord, having a minimum tensile breaking strength of 75 pounds. Each handle shall extend not less than 3-1/2 inches nor more than 4 inches from top of bag. The handle shall be secured between the reinforcing strip around the mouth of the bag and the bag body.

3.3 Dimensions. The approximate dimensions of the bags, shall be as shown in table I, $\pm$ 1/4 inch. The dimensions are furnished only as a guide. Bags produced by different manufacturers may vary somewhat and be considered acceptable, providing that such bags meet the applicable minimum cubic inch capacity as specified in table I.

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TABLE I. Type I (satchel bottom) and type II (self-opening) bags (Capacities and Dimensions)

Type	Face (A) width (Inches)	Bottom (C) width (Inches)	Bag (D) width (Inches)	Capacity[1] Cu. inch (Tolerance minus 2 percent)
I	17	6	17-3/4	1171
II	13	6	17-3/4	1384
II	13	6	16	1248

[1] The capacity shall be determined by the method of measuring bags and computing their cubic capacity as specified in 4.3.1.2.

TABLE II. Weights and strength of paper

Basis weight[2] 24 x 36 - 500 (Tolerance ± 5 percent) Pounds	Average bursting strength[2] (min.) Points	Average tearing resistance machine direction[2] (min.) Grams
60 - 97.6 (g./sq. m.)	38	121
65 - 105.8 (g./sq. m.)	41	131

[2] See 4.4.1.

3.4 Workmanship. Workmanship shall be first class throughout. Bags shall be uniformly constructed, free from holes, tears, cuts, splits or other defects which might impair their usefulness.

4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

4.1 Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the supplier is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified in the contract or order, the supplier may use his own or any other facilities suitable for the performance of the inspection requirements specified herein, unless disapproved by the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

4.2 Inspection of components and materials. In accordance with 4.1, the supplier is responsible for insuring that materials and components used were manufactured, tested and inspected in accordance with the requirements of referenced subsidiary specifications and standards to the extent specified, or, if none, in accordance with this specification. In event of conflict, this specification will govern.

4.3 Inspection of the end item.

4.3.1 Examination of the end item. The end item shall be examined in accordance with the classification of defects set forth in the applicable examination paragraphs at the inspection levels and acceptable quality levels (AQL's) in 4.3.1.5. Not more than one bag randomly selected, shall be drawn from any one package from each lot for each type weight and size offered for acceptance for visual and dimensional characteristics. The lot size, for purpose of determining the sample size in accordance with MIL-STD-105, shall be expressed in units of packages, of the applicable quantity of each type and size bag, for examinations under 4.3.1.1, 4.3.1.2, 4.3.1.3, and in units of shipping containers for examination under 4.3.1.4.

4.3.1.1 Examination of the end item for defects in construction, workmanship and dimensions.

Examine	Defect
Type	Not type specified.
Workmanship	Surfaces not clean: spots, shives, lumps, dirt spots, tears, cuts, holes, scuff marks which weaken the paper.
Construction	Seams poorly glued, do not adhere securely throughout their entire area.
	Folded edges not parallel to or perpendicular to unfolded edges of bags.
	Handles not secured, properly located or of material specified.
	Construction of bag not in conformance with contract requirements for the applicable bag

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Examine	Defect
Capacity	More than 2 percent below the contractual requirements for the specified type and size (see table I).
Dimensions	Any dimension varying by more than ± 1/4 inch.

4.3.1.2 Method of measuring the bags and computing their capacity. A scale graduated in eighths of an inch shall be used in making the measurements (see point of measure, fig. 1).

4.3.1.2.1 Type I, satchel bottom bags.

4.3.1.2.1.1 Face width, A. Measure across the front of bag just above the top of the bottom fold.

4.3.1.2.1.2 Bottom width, C. With the bag in closed position and fold to the front, measure along center of fold from the bottom edge to its upper edge

4.3.1.2.1.3 Bag length, D. Measure along the center of the bag from the lower edge of the fold to the extreme top edge of the bag.

4.3.1.2.1.4 Cubic capacity. Cubic capacity (A-C) x (CXD) is the product of capacity width, bottom width and bag length.

4.3.1.2.2 Type II, self-opening (automatic) bags.

4.3.1.2.2.1 Face width, A. With bottom fold to the front position, measure across the front of the folded bag just above the top of the bottom fold.

4.3.1.2.2.2 Tuck width, C. Spread the bag so that the tucks normally behind the face are fully extended, outward. Press the bag flat and measure full width as close to the bottom fold as possible. Subtracting the face width from this measurement, gives dimension C.

4.3.1.2.2.3 Bag length, D. Measure along center of the front face of the bag, from the lower bottom to the extreme top edge.

4.3.1.2.2.4 Cubic capacity. Cubic capacity (A X C X D) is the product of the face width, bottom width and length of the bag.

4.3.1.3 Examination of the end item for count per package. The sample unit for this examination shall be one unit bundle (250 bags). The average count per package shall be not less than the quantity specified.

4.3.1.4 Examination of preparation for delivery. An examination shall be made to determine that packing and markings comply with the requirements of section 5 of this specification. The sample unit shall be one shipping container, fully packed, selected just prior to the closing operation. Shipping containers fully prepared for delivery shall be examined for closure defects.

Examine	Defect
Packing	Not level specified; not in accordance with contract requirements. Container material not as specified; closures not accomplished as specified or required methods or materials.
Weight (as applicable)	Gross or net weight exceeds contract requirements.
Marking	Marking missing, illegible or incorrect.

4.3.2 Inspection levels and acceptable quality levels (AQL's) for examinations. The inspection levels, for determining the sample size, and the acceptable quality levels (AQL's) expressed as defects per 100 units, shall be as follows:

Examination paragraph	Inspection level	AQL's
4.3.1.1	S-3	4.0
4.3.1.3	S-3	---
4.3.1.4	S-2	4.0

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4.3.2 Testing of the end item. Testing shall be performed for the characteristics as indicated in table I on samples randomly selected from each lot of bags offered for Government acceptance. The sample unit shall be one bag. Failure to meet the AQL, as indicated, shall be cause for rejection of the lot.

4.4 Tests.

4.4.1 Test methods. The following test shall be conducted in accordance with TAPPI methods described on materials used in the fabrication of the bags.

Requirement	Test Method
Fiber Analysis of Paper and Paperboard	T401
Conditioning Paper and Paperboard for Testing	T402
Bursting Strength of Paper	T403
Rosin in Paper and Paperboard	T408
Basis Weight of Paper and Paperboard	T410
Internal Tearing Resistance of Paper	T414

5. PREPARATION FOR DELIVERY

5.1 Packing. Packing shall be level A, B or C, as specified (see 6.1).

5.1.1 Level A. Bags of like description, in quantities as specified (see 6.1), shall be packed in a close-fitting box conforming to PPP-B-636, class weather-resistant. The box shall be closed and strapped in accordance with the appendix to the box specification.

5.1.2 Level B. Two hundred and fifty (250) bags, reversed end to end in quantities of 25 or 50, shall be packed in a close-fitting box conforming to PPP-B-636, class domestic. The box shall be closed and sealed in accordance with the appendix to the box specification.

5.1.3 Level C. Bags shall be packed to afford adequate protection against physical and environmental damage during shipment, handling and limited storage. Containers shall be in accordance with Uniform Freight Classification rules or National Motor Freight Classification rules, as applicable.

5.3. Marking. In addition to markings required by the contract or order, the shipping containers shall be marked in accordance with Fed. Std. No. 123 or MIL-STD-129, as applicable.

6. NOTES

6.1 Ordering data. Purchasers should select the preferred options permitted herein and include the following information in procurement documents:

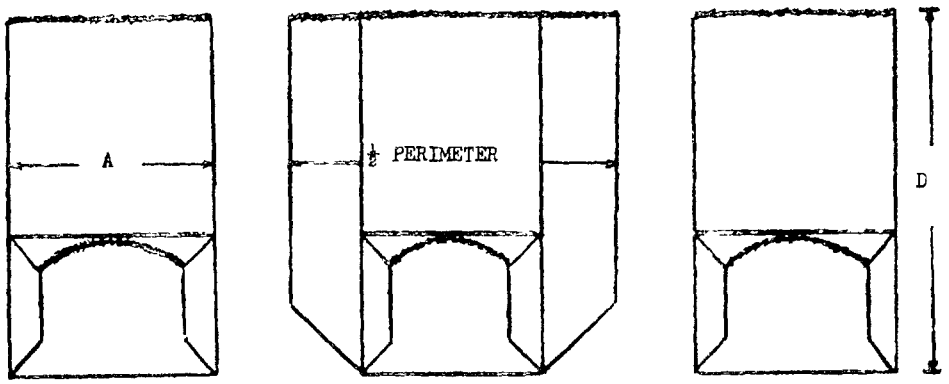
(a) Title, number and date of this specification.
(b) Type and size of bag required (table I).
(c) When bags of other weights of paper are required (3.1.3).
(d) Level of packing required (5.1).

Preparing activity.

GSA-FSS

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SELF-OPENING (AUTOMATIC) BAGS



SATCHEL-BOTTOM BAGS

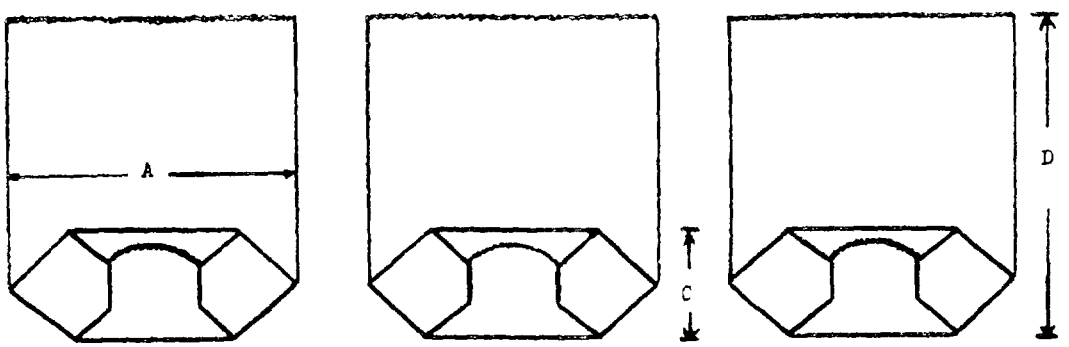


FIGURE 1

Orders for this publication are to be placed with the General Services Administration, acting as an agent for the Superintendent of Documents. See section 2 of this specification to obtain extra copies and other documents referenced herein. Price 10 cents each

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